# Rootd — Onboarding & Application Workflow Spec (Draft v1)

**Scope:** Full Pathway (NLV, DNV) new applications + Renewal, for the front-door questionnaire through to submission-ready.
**Out of scope for this draft:** Standalone Single Application (PR/Citizenship) — shares the country/existing-permit question, but its own eligibility engine, document set, and questionnaire are not detailed here (separate spec needed, given its distinct UPL profile).
**Status:** Pre-build, validation stage. Not yet reviewed by an immigration-law advisor.

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## 1. Problem Statement

New users currently have no way to reliably see whether they qualify for a Spanish visa, what documents they'll need, or how to sequence a multi-step application — the app needs to convert that uncertainty into a concrete, personalized checklist from the very first session, with no wasted branch for users who already hold a permit and just need to renew.

Without a mandatory, upfront data-gathering step, the checklist that follows is either empty (offering no real value) or built on partial guesses — undermining the trust-building purpose of the free tier described in the wider Rootd summary.

## 2. Goals

- 100% of new users reach a dashboard with a checklist that reflects their actual situation (no user reaches an empty checklist).
- Users with an existing NLV/DNV can reach a renewal-specific flow within the same entry point, without being routed through new-application questions irrelevant to them.
- Users can learn what each visa is (definition, purpose) before committing to one, without the app making a personalized recommendation.
- Questionnaire completion time stays short enough that drop-off before reaching the dashboard (the first payoff moment) is minimized.

## 3. Non-Goals

- **No skip option.** Previously considered, explicitly reversed — every new user answers the full questionnaire before reaching the dashboard. (Note: this is a real trade-off against activation speed; see Open Questions.)
- **No app-driven visa recommendation.** The app shows definitions and lets the user choose; it never suggests "you should apply for X" based on answers. Recommending would cross the UPL line from factual/informational into advisory.
- **No verification of self-reported existing-permit status.** Rootd has no persistent case record yet to confirm a user's claimed NLV/DNV is real; this version trusts what the user reports.
- **Standalone Single Application (PR/Citizenship) flow.** Shares the first two questions (country, existing permit)

conceptually, but its distinct eligibility logic and document set are not specified here.

- **Group/family/shared accounts.** Already logged as out of scope elsewhere.

## 4. User Stories

**First-time NLV/DNV applicant**

- As a first-time applicant, I want to be asked which country I'm targeting, so the app knows which rules to apply (even though only Spain is active today).
- As a first-time applicant, I want to see what NLV and DNV actually mean before choosing one, so I can pick the right corridor without needing outside research.
- As a first-time applicant, I want the questionnaire to ask only what's relevant to the visa I picked, so I'm not answering irrelevant questions.
- As a first-time applicant, I want my checklist pre-filled the moment I finish the questionnaire, so I immediately see what I still need to do.

**Existing permit holder (renewal)**

- As an NLV/DNV holder in Spain, I want to indicate I already have a permit early on, so I'm routed to renewal questions instead of new-application questions.
- As a renewal applicant, I want to confirm updated income and residency details, so my renewal checklist reflects my current situation, not my original filing.

**All users**

- As a user, I want to see a clear message once every requirement is marked complete, so I know I'm ready to submit.
- As a user, I want to see the correct destination for submission (embassy for new applications, local immigration office for renewals), so I don't send my file to the wrong place.
- As a user, I want to save my progress and come back later, so an incomplete session isn't lost.
- As a user, I want a notes section on my dashboard, so I can jot down things to remember about my specific case.

## 5. Requirements

### Must-Have (P0)

#### Questionnaire entry sequence

- Q1: Which country? (Spain selectable now; other countries visibly listed as "coming soon" — no functional effect yet)
- Q2: Do you already hold a visa or permit? (Yes/No, self-reported, no verification)
  - *Acceptance:* Yes → renewal path. No → new-application path. No way to leave this question blank and proceed.
- No (new application): Which visa are you applying for? Shows NLV and DNV (Standalone visas listed separately per current scope note), each tappable for a plain-language definition and purpose.
  - *Acceptance:* Viewing a definition never displays eligibility language ("you qualify"/"you don't qualify") or a recommendation — display copy is descriptive only.

- Yes (renewal): Which permit are you renewing? (NLV or DNV)

**Visa-specific questionnaire (mandatory, both new and renewal)**

- New application: asks the questions needed to pre-fill NLV or DNV requirements (income, income source, work status, dependents, etc.)
- Renewal: asks for updated income, proof of continued residency, and other renewal-relevant facts.
- *Acceptance:* User cannot reach the dashboard without completing this step. No skip/back-out control is shown.

**Dashboard**

- Checklist pre-filled from questionnaire answers, organized by category.
- Each requirement is independently clickable; supports text entry and file upload.
- Status per requirement: **Green** (complete), **Yellow** (started, missing info or file), **Grey** (not required for this user, disabled/non-interactive).
- Save-and-resume: user can leave and return with all progress intact.
- Notes section: free-text field for the user's own reminders, tied to the application.

**Submission readiness**

- Once all non-grey requirements are Green, dashboard shows a clear "ready to submit" message.
- Displays the correct destination: embassy address (new applications) or local immigration office (renewals).

- Displays the lawyer directory entry point (per existing Legal File Review flow) and the AI document generation entry point (paid, per existing pricing model — not re-specified here).

### Nice-to-Have (P1)

- Progress indicator during the questionnaire (e.g., "Step 2 of 5") to offset the removal of skip and reduce perceived friction.
- Definitions surfaced as a lightweight modal/expand rather than navigating away from the visa list, so browsing stays fast.
- Ability to revisit and edit earlier questionnaire answers after reaching the dashboard, with a clear disclosure of what will re-calculate on the checklist.

### Future Considerations (P2)

- Persistent case record that could later verify a claimed existing permit against Rootd's own history (only possible once a user's original application was filed through Rootd).
- Country selector becoming functional for markets beyond Spain.
- Standalone (PR/Citizenship) questionnaire and checklist, once its own eligibility engine is scoped.

## 6. Success Metrics

#### Leading

- Questionnaire completion rate (started → reached dashboard). Target and baseline: TBD, no prior data.

- Time to complete questionnaire (median). Target: TBD — should be benchmarked once a first draft of the actual question set exists.
- % of dashboard requirements marked Green within the first session vs. requiring a return visit.

**Lagging**

- Free-to-paid conversion at the AI document generation step (existing funnel metric, this flow feeds into it).
- Renewal-path completion rate among users who self-identify as existing permit holders.

## 7. Open Questions

- **(Legal)** Does showing visa definitions on request need review to confirm the copy stays descriptive and doesn't imply eligibility judgment?
- **(Legal)** Is a self-reported "yes" to holding an existing permit sufficient, or does the renewal path need a lighter factual check (e.g., permit number entry) before proceeding — without becoming a document-validity judgment?
- **(Product)** Is removing the skip option worth the activation-rate risk? No data yet to model expected drop-off; this is currently a judgment call, not a validated decision.
- **(Engineering)** Does renewal reuse the NLV/DNV eligibility engine with added fields, or does it need its own rule set? This affects the "three rule sets" knowledge-base burden already tracked for the project.
- **(Product)** Where does the embassy address / local office data come from, and how is it kept current as government contact info changes?

- **(Design)** Should the "which visa to apply for" list also surface Standalone (PR/Citizenship) as options here, or should Standalone have a fully separate entry point given its different engine and higher UPL profile?

## 8. Timeline Considerations

- This flow depends on the NLV/DNV eligibility rule sets already being defined (existing Phase 1 work).
- Renewal being pulled into Phase 1 (per this session's decision) means this spec's renewal path needs its own rule set defined before engineering can build the "Confirm renewal details" step — currently a dependency, not yet resolved.
- No hard external deadline identified; sequencing depends on the broader Phase 1 build plan, which already needs revisiting for the Standalone and Renewal additions.